



Transistor radio

- **What?** Regency TR-1
- **Who?** Texas Instruments and Idea Inc.
- **Where and when?** US, 1954

The Regency TR-1 transformed the radio from a piece of bulky furniture to something that could be put in a pocket. What made this possible was the transistor, a tiny, solid device developed in 1947 that replaced bulky glass tubes for amplifying signals. Texas Instruments supplied the transistors and Idea Inc. designed and produced the gadget that changed the way the world listened to music.

WOW!

More than half the world's population is not connected to the Internet, so for many, radio is still the most accessible form of communication.

Portable radio

- **What?** TR82
- **Who?** Bush
- **Where and when?** UK, 1959

The first transistor radios were expensive, but soon other manufacturers entered the market with cheaper models. One of the most iconic of the first wave of portable radios was the TR82 transistor radio by British company

Bush, which launched in 1959. Its fashionable design by David Ogle, with a large central dial inscribed with the names of various radio stations, made it immensely popular, especially with teenagers. It is now considered a design classic.



Digital radio

- **What?** Alpha 10
- **Who?** Arcam
- **Where and when?** UK, 1999

Although digital broadcasting was pioneered in the 1980s, the world's first digital radio tuner intended for home use did not go on sale until 1999. It was big and expensive. Smaller, more affordable units began to appear over the next few years, such as the pioneering Evoke 1 from British company Pure in 2002.

Walkie-talkie

- **What?** AM SCR-536
- **Who?** Motorola
- **Where and when?** US, 1940

What we now know as a walkie-talkie was originally called a "handie-talkie"—in other words, a handheld, two-way radio. The first example to appear was the AM SCR-536, made by Motorola. It was made for the military and was quite bulky. It was soon succeeded by smaller, lighter models, popular with service organizations and on work sites.



UFT 432 walkie-talkie, 1970s

Buttons make switching stations and modes easier.

